

AI Product Manager Skills Checklist

Reference checklist converted from the provided workbook | Written by Brian McCarthy

Checklist

Skill / Competency / Technique / Area of Expertise	Definition	Classification
Abstract Thinking	The ability to look beyond the immediate problem or issue and envision a more wholistic view	General Skill
AI Advocacy	Be able to advocate for AI initiatives within the organization. Drive understanding, consensus, and alignment	AI Specific Skill
AI Algorithms	A set of rules or instructions that enables computers to learn, analyze data, perform tasks, and make decisions autonomously	AI Specific Skill
AI Bias	AI bias, also known as machine learning bias or algorithm bias, refers to the occurrence of biased results due to human biases that skew the original training data or AI algorithm	AI Specific Skill
AI Strategic Vision	Understand how AI aligns with business goals and user needs	AI Specific Skill
AI Translation	Translate AI concepts and definitions into clear communication for various stakeholders	AI Specific Skill
AI User-Centric Mindset	Ensure AI products meet user needs and deliver value	AI Specific Skill
Analysis Skills	A general management skill. Analyze and use reliable data to make educated and focused product decisions	General Skill
Analytical Skills	Know how to use the data you can access to address issues and develop solutions that ultimately lead to a successful product launch	General Skill
Analytical Thinking	Allows a Product Manager to create a sense of order, stay organized, communicate effectively across cross-functional teams, and make logical and rational decisions	General Skill
Artificial Intelligence (AI) Understanding	Understand how AI technologies work and their potential applications	AI Specific Skill
Attention to Detail	An organizational skill. Be able to understand specific activities that must be accomplished and organize the product team in a manner where they do things right	General Skill
Brain Writing	A technique where participants are given an opportunity to think about questions that will be asked prior to the brainstorming session. These ideas are documented on paper, sticky notes, or even electronically to be shared or discussed	General Skill
Brainstorming	Allows a group to share ideas and opinions in a manner that enables the generation of multiple new ideas and thoughts about a subject in a short time	General Skill
Business Acumen	The ability to understand and manage various business situations	General Skill
Business Skills	A general management skill. Ensure value and Return on Investment (ROI) are achieved. Manage cash flow and calculate financial metrics	General Skill
Collaboration	A process through which a group of people constructively explore their ideas to search for a solution that extends one's own limited vision	General Skill
Communications Skills	A general management skill. Regularly share ideas and convey objectives and priorities in an easy-to-understand manner	General Skill
Continuous Learning	Stay updated and knowledgeable on AI advancements, business trends, and emerging AI technologies.	AI Specific Skill
Core Benefit Identification	One of Kotler's Five Levels of a Product. Products and services that have the features or functionality to satisfy a customer's basic wants and needs	General Skill
Customer Empathy Identification	The ability to put yourself in the "customer's shoes." Understand the customers' needs and wants	General Skill
Data Pipelines	An end-to-end sequence of digital processes used to collect, modify, and deliver data	AI Specific Skill

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Data-Driven Decision Making	The process of collecting data based on your company's key performance indicators (KPIs) and transforming that data into actionable insights	AI Specific Skill
Decision-Making	Ability to come to a decision quickly and begin to take action on that decision immediately. Avoid analysis paralysis	General Skill
Deep Learning	Subset of machine learning. Algorithms use multiple layers to progressively extract higher-level features from raw input data	AI Specific Skill
Delegation	An organizational skill. identify all required activities, determine who is best suited to accomplish each activity, assign realistic and clear roles and responsibilities, and control and monitor results	General Skill
Delphi Technique	A facilitation method where ideas and information can be gained from a panel of experts using surveys or alternative methods. In many cases, anonymity of inputs is maintained.	General Skill
Differentiation Analysis	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Share how your product differs from other products. Highlight functionality or features you offer that the competition can't match	General Skill
Elevator Pitch Development	A standard six-sigma tool used to tell a product story in an accurate, brief, and concise manner. Often used to develop a Product Vision	General Skill
Engineering Awareness	Help develop technical solutions to enhance product effectiveness and functionality	General Skill
Experimentation	Involves exploring, testing, and refining artificial intelligence models, algorithms, and systems	AI Specific Skill
Facilitation	Enables people to get together to achieve a common goal and directs their focus and attention in ways that serve the group itself	General Skill
Focus identification	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Try to find a niche. Look for features and functionality that no competitor can provide	General Skill
Generative AI	Refers to technology that can create new content, such as text, images, or code, based on patterns learned from existing data	AI Specific Skill
Ideation	The generation of new ideas	General Skill
Influencing	Simply defined as motivating people to do what you need them to do.	General Skill
Innovation	The execution of a new or improved product, process, marketing method, or organizational method in business practices, workplace organization, or external relations	General Skill
Machine Learning	A branch of artificial intelligence (AI) and computer science that focuses on using data and algorithms to imitate the way humans learn.	AI Specific Skill
Market Segmentation Expertise	A marketing strategy that divides consumers into groups based on their needs, interests, behavior or demographics	General Skill
Marketing Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to achieve effective product design, packaging, promotion, and pricing	General Skill
Marketing Skills	A general management skill. Promote and deliver products and services in the most efficient and successful ways possible	General Skill
Messaging	The way you communicate the value of your product to customers	General Skill
Multi-Tasking Ability	An organizational skill. Be aware of the "Two Hat Syndrome." Break out your activities, try to focus on the most critical product management related tasks, and delegate when you can.	General Skill
Nominal Group Technique	Ideas are discussed and annotated. Each participant then is asked to rank each idea to aid in prioritization	General Skill
Organizational Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Planning and executing new methods to develop or improve an organization's business practices, workplace organization, and external relations	General Skill
Primary Research Ability	Going to actual or potential customers in order to gain first-hand data or information. Primary research allows you to target your actual questions to the desired segment	General Skill
Prioritization Skills	A general management skill. Ensure that all team members are contributing to the most important tasks and using their time appropriately	General Skill

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Problem Solving	Allows a Product Manager to identify a problem, potential causes, identify root causes, and develop practical solutions	General Skill
Process Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to accomplish common goals that include faster delivery, less waste, and optimizing use of resources	General Skill
Product Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation essential when introducing a product or service with features and functionality that are new or improved	General Skill
Product Management Expertise	The process of conceiving, planning, developing, testing, launching, delivering, and withdrawing products	General Skill
Product Roadmap Development	A high-level visual summary that maps out the vision, direction, priorities, and progress of a product over time.	General Skill
Radical Innovation Planning	Radical innovation proposes large changes to the existing product landscape. It aims to plan and implement large improvements by redefining the product	General Skill
Research Skills	A general management skill. Ensure all decisions are based on sound data and logic. Use Primary and secondary research techniques effectively	General Skill
Retrospective Facilitation	Inspect work that was completed, recommend changes, and adapt processes and behavior in ways to improve performance in the next Sprint	General Skill
Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Leadership	The art of making your website more visible and relevant to people who search online for products or services related to your business	General Skill
Secondary Research Ability	A method of collecting information that relies on indirect methods such as published reports, public or commercial databases, websites, agencies, surveys, etc.	General Skill
Self-Motivation	An organizational skill. Set singular goals that add the most value and accomplish them one at a time. Mentally reward yourself when things go well and remain optimistic in light of challenges	General Skill
SMART Goal Development	Goals that are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound	General Skill
Storytelling	Helps the Product Manager create a compelling vision for their products by putting them in a larger context	General Skill
Strategic Thinking	A general management skill. Understand the market and decide how to launch a new product effectively	General Skill
Strategy	Envisioning a desired outcome, charting an efficient course to achieve this objective, and aligning to that course as long as it makes sense to do so	General Skill
SWOT Analysis	An analysis tool that stands for strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats. This is an appropriate tool to help guide business development objectives	General Skill
Technical Expertise	A general management skill. Ensure the product meets end-user expectations regarding its function, design and user experience	General Skill
Time Management	An organizational skill. Work within tight deadlines set by management and customers alike. They must be able to establish realistic schedules and manage the team to achieve all key milestones and deliverable requirements	General Skill
Working Under Pressure	An organizational skill. Breakdown large projects into smaller and more understandable steps. Stay organized and focus on the most important tasks. Don't get lost in the details. Do not procrastinate and avoid dysfunctional conflict as much as possible	General Skill